



Working together

*to enhance safety, reduce congestion and maximize economic development
along the U.S. Highway 169 interregional corridor.*

2013-2014 Work Plan

Primary Goals for 2013-2014

1. Support and Advocate for the US 169 Project Priorities by promoting awareness of needs and support development of funding programs.
2. Raise interest in and awareness of Transit and Passenger Rail needs and work with MnDOT and MPO's to strengthen support for Transit and Passenger Rail options in the corridor.
3. Continue Education efforts to develop a better understanding of transportation and economic development linkages along the corridor.

Work Plan to Support Goals

Goal #1: Support and Advocate for the US 169 Project Priorities by promoting awareness of needs and support development of funding programs.

(List developed by the Technical Committee in 2012)

1. Work to get US 169 priority projects on MnDOT's lists
 - a. Individual member agencies and communities recognize, support and present corridor priorities when participating in state and regional planning process
 - b. Executive committee seeks annual meeting with each district engineer, Commissioner of Transportation and MPO director to raise awareness of corridor needs and priorities
2. Advocate for funding programs to address corridor needs
 - a. Raise awareness in the legislature about funding needs of the DOT and MPOs to support corridor priorities and needs
 - i. Annual legislative outreach meeting with corridor legislators to educate and raise awareness of needs and programs that benefit the corridor
 - ii. Hold a work session of the full board with the legislative transportation committee chairs to discuss funding and policy direction to support investment in IRCs
 - iii. Hold an annual work session with the Commissioner of Transportation to

discuss funding and policy direction to support IRC investment – the ask this year should be to get DOT to commit resources to update the IRC studies

1. New type of study that focuses on economic importance of corridor to communities and examines system linkages (i.e. US 14, I 494, Savage ports, TH212) and how changing demographics will influence corridor needs, The study should identify phased improvements opportunities consistent with the 2003 Interregional Corridor Management Plan vision and include other include other modes, particularly transit.
- iv. Board should seek opportunities to tell the story of the corridor importance to the legislature and the need for funding programs to enable DOT to support investment in programs like TED, SaM, Flood Mitigation, CIMS, RALF that support infrastructure, safety and capacity needs of the corridor
3. Improve information available to educate about the corridor
 - a. Technical committee should review and revise project data including cost estimates and one pagers, brochures, presentations and maps during first half of the year
 - b. Develop a one pager on what the next iteration of IRC study should look like
 - c. All information should be made available to the board members on Coalition website
 - d. Individual Coalition members should provide success stories and project updates on an annual basis to the technical committee for use in web page and other public information
 - e. Technical committee should inventory and verify the degree that the project priorities have been identified in various local and regional plans (transportation plans, comprehensive plans)

Goal #2: Raise interest in and awareness of Transit and Passenger Rail needs of the corridor and work with MnDOT and MPO's to strengthen support for Transit and Passenger Rail options in the corridor.

1. Engage and influence the Met Council transitway study process
 - a. Hold a work session at the full board meeting
 - b. Technical committee should become engaged and participate in the process
 - c. Board members should support process and advocate for 169 corridor through participation in workshops and involvement and presence at TAB, Transportation Committee and Met Council meeting participation.
2. Take a leadership role to move forward a long haul study
 - a. Coalition provides \$50,000
 - b. Request funding match/commitments from the counties/cities along the corridor
 - c. Technical committee scope out long haul study scope from Metro Area to Mankato by May for the board approval to move forward
 - d. Study underway by June with completion in by March 2014
3. Monitor the activities of the rail industry for opportunities for freight and passenger rail
4. Monitor and report on regional transit planning activities
5. Increase awareness and understanding of federal funding opportunities like small

starts program and other grant programs administered by DOT and MPOs

Goal 3: Continue Education efforts to develop a better understanding of transportation and economic development linkages along the corridor.

1. Corridor advocate will arrange and facilitate three (3) outreach meetings with the business community in 2013 (review for 2014) to promote awareness, increase understanding of business communities' transportation needs and build public-private partnership opportunities and relationships and build affiliate membership (February, June, October – meetings need confirmation)
 - a. Staffing committee (Shukle, McNeil, Hulting) will evaluate effectiveness of events
2. Work to engage local communities north of I-494 to I-94 in the work of coalition (Ed Shukle volunteered to work on this)
3. Meet annually with DEED and other economic development arms serving corridor including Greater Mankato Growth, Metro MSP

General Work Plan Tasks/Responsibilities to Meet Agreed Upon Goals

1. Executive committee to meet monthly; conference call capabilities for these meetings should be provided but when possible attendance in person is encouraged
 - a. Corridor advocate services reviewed, goals set and contract revised as needed
 - b. Service/vendors determined by executive committee (exec & TAC discussion item)
 - c. Per the Coalition Joint Powers Agreement, the executive committee shall develop and recommend the upcoming annual budget and annual dues structure for Board adoption
 - 2014 Budget adoption
 - 2014 Dues Structure adoption
 - Treasurer to certify 2014 Budget & Dues notices to Coalition members
 - d. Annual work program development
 - e. Executive committee recruitment
 - f. Executive committee structure may be broadened to include others (i.e. committee chairs or members)
2. Full board meets every other month
 - a. Meetings to focus on workshops and policy development/discussion
 - i. January/February legislative workshop
 - ii. March meeting on transitway study; review updated materials
 - iii. May update with transportation committee chairs (invited)
 - iv. July meeting with Commissioner Zelle/Budget and Dues
 - v. September DEED meeting
 - vi. November long haul study/2014 work program
 - b. Encourage board members to be involved in local business outreach activities facilitated by corridor advocates
 - c. Engage board members in legislative initiatives and project advocacy as needed

- d. Approve Annual Budget and Dues
 - e. Concur with executive committee work program
- 3. Corridor advocate – membership recruitment and board meeting administration
 - a. Three (3) business outreach events (February, June, October)
 - b. Other recruitment efforts as directed by executive committee
 - c. Board and executive committee administrative support
 - i. Meeting logistics
 - ii. Speaker and workshop coordination
 - iii. Agendas
 - iv. Minutes
 - v. Annual Newsletter
- 4. Technical committee continues to meet monthly; every other month the technical committee will meet concurrently with the executive committee and alternating month independently
 - a. Responsibilities include oversight of website, technical studies, one pagers and presentation materials
 - b. Assist corridor advocate with speakers and board workshop development as requested
- 5. Treasurer support /accounting responsibilities currently handled by Scott County including annual billing, member list updates/maintenance coordinated with corridor advocate, insurance renewal
 - a. Treasurer needs to establish annual audit process and reporting requirements